

LMFT CLINICAL EXAMINATION

Resources and Sample Questions

LMFT CLINICAL EXAMINATION RESOURCES

Board of Behavioral Sciences Statutes and Regulations Relating to the Practice of Professional Clinical Counseling, Marriage and Family Therapy, Educational Psychology, and Clinical Social Work.

<https://www.bbs.ca.gov/pdf/publications/lawsregs.pdf>

LMFT CLINICAL EXAMINATION SAMPLE QUESTIONS

Correct answers are in bold text.

Sample Question 1 - Clinical Evaluation

A 25-year-old client initiates therapy with complaints of chronic depression and lack of motivation. The client currently lives with his grandparents, does not have any money, and is attempting to finish graduate school. He discloses that his parents had a traumatic divorce several years ago and he fears he will become like his father, who had an emotional breakdown and abused his mother. The client currently has a girlfriend who lives in another state, and he says he feels alone without her. Which of the following actions should the therapist take to assess this client?

- A. **Gather family history, explore client's strengths, identify coping mechanisms**
- B. Gather family history, determine somatic symptoms, identify familial coping patterns
- C. Explore substance use, determine somatic symptoms, identify coping mechanisms
- D. Explore substance use, explore client's strengths, identify familial coping patterns

Sample Question 2 - Crisis Management

A 36-year-old client initiates therapy and reports that the previous night she went on a date with a man she had met online. After dinner he raped her and then dropped her off at home as if nothing happened. She tells the therapist that she spent the night in the emergency room, and is afraid to go home because her assaulter knows where she lives. Which of the following actions should the therapist initially take in this crisis situation?

- E. Re-establish the client's feelings of control to reduce her sense of victimization
- F. **Evaluate the client's support systems to identify a safe place for the client to stay**
- G. Develop the client's trauma narrative of the event to desensitize emotional impact
- H. Encourage the client to file a police report to protect other women from the perpetrator

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Sample Question 3 – Treatment Planning

A 7-year-old client is brought to therapy by his mother, who states that the client has been moody and defiant at home and has been fighting with other children at school. She states that the client's change in behavior began four months ago, following a foreclosure of the house that the family had lived in for several years. She further states that the client's father did not move with them to the new apartment, and that despite the fact that he works constantly, they still face eviction so she is refusing to let him see the client. Which of the following goals should be included in the treatment plan for this case?

- A. Decrease fighting at school and defiance at home
Re-establish appropriate relationships between family members
Refer the mother for financial assistance
- B. **Decrease fighting at school and defiance at home**
Re-establish appropriate relationships between family members
Refer the mother for anger management
- C. Enhance impulse-control and attention span
Explore the marital relationship
Refer the mother for financial assistance
- D. Enhance impulse-control and attention span
Explore the marital relationship
Refer the mother for anger management

Sample Question 4 – Treatment

A 19-year-old college student is referred to therapy by her physician for symptoms of panic. Her physician declined to prescribe medication until the client has initiated therapy. The client, however, believes that only medication will control her symptoms and that therapy is a "waste of time." Which of the following interventions would a cognitive-behavioral therapist use to address the client's participation in therapy?

- A. Interpret the client's distorted cognitions and identify their connection to her current symptoms of panic
- B. Explore the client's disappointment with her physician and validate her automatic thoughts as a logical consequence
- C. **Examine the client's assumptions regarding treatment and collaborate with her to promote a shift in personal conclusions**
- D. Role-play with the client to increase her assertiveness and encourage her to communicate her concerns directly with her physician

Sample Question 5 – Law

A 47-year-old client is referred for therapy by his pastor for complaints of problems in his marriage. The client wants to work on issues that involve only him, but mentions that he was in therapy with his wife several months ago. He wants to obtain the records from the previous therapist, but does not want his wife to know he has sought treatment alone. Which of the following actions should the therapist take in this situation?

- A. Have the client sign a release to obtain treatment records that pertain to him
- B. Contact the previous therapist to request summary records of the client's therapy
- C. **Inform the client that the couple must each sign a release for previous treatment records**
- D. Reassure the client that the records are not necessary because the treatment focus has changed

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Sample Question 6 – Ethics

A therapist is currently involved in a contentious divorce and perceives his spouse as aggressive and unreasonable. The therapist begins meeting weekly with a colleague for consultation to prevent his feelings from impacting therapy with his clients. Three weeks later, a client who has been in ongoing therapy for symptoms of depression begins describing relationship difficulties that are similar to what the therapist is experiencing. Which of the following actions should the therapist take to manage the ethical issues involved in this case?

- A. **Provide continued treatment to the client and discuss the case with the colleague to monitor own feelings**
- B. Utilize limited self-disclosure and reassure the client of the therapist's understanding to enhance therapeutic empathy
- C. Explain the potential for bias on the part of the therapist and refer the client to an alternate therapist to provide ongoing treatment
- D. Contain the therapist's own feelings and focus discussions on the client's depression to maintain consistency with established treatment goals